Suddaby School Council

April 15, 2024

Present: Barb Tomkins, Sarah Taylor, Katha Broschek, Karin Korth, Lisa Farlow, Mel McShane, Sue Campbell, Jill Kraft,Samantha McLaughlin, Simon McNaughton, Kate Leslie,Joel Leslie, Katie Elder, Lisa Lynette, Helena, Ian Van der pool
Regrets: Tiina Rendas, Amanda Hunter, Tiffany Moore, Katherine Akins, Annie Doran, Neil Callaghan

Administrators' Report:

1. Clubs Currently Running:

- Chess club
- Gr. 6 Floor Hockey
- Yarn Club
- GSA
- Soccer club and Skipping Club starting up

2. Class Trips:

- Recent trips have included KPL and Blair Road Outdoor Education Centre

3. Power of Perseverance Assembly: Grades 1-6-April 3

- Successful assembly for grades 1-6. The presenter juggled and rode a unicycle and talked to students about the importance of perseverance. He provided strategies for students to use in order to keep on trying such as practicing a skill several times rather than giving up, asking for help and using the word "yet" or positive self-talk to show a growth mindset.

4. White Hatter Presentation:

- Successful virtual presentation for grades 4-6, complemented by a virtual presentation for caregiversBoth presentations had lots of positive feedback from teachers, students, and parents.

5. EQAO:

- Window to administer is from May 8 to June 12, 2024. Caregivers will receive more information from the class teacher if applicable once dates are set. Educators will reach out to families to let them know when their class is scheduled to complete the EQAO assessment.

6. Community Picnic:

- Save the Date: June 21, 2024.

Teachers' Report:

- Mme. Kraft raised issues regarding the annual Dance-a-thon fundraiser:
    - The music played is not inclusive to all students
    - Some students' cultures do not permit dancing
    - Suggested that the Dance-a-thon be changed to a Move-a-thon, with "stations" set up for different movements
    - Noted that changing the name of the event is insufficient; the spirit of the event must change
    - Council to reflect and discuss during next year's planning

Financial Report:

Total Funds:	$32,186.18
Class $ set aside for (unclaimed) class transportation funds:	$2329.00
Discretionary funds for this SY:	$1035.43
Earmarked for fundraising expenses:	$1215.00

Fundraising Report:

- **Popcorn Day:** made $445, approx 50% is profit

- **Trivia Night:** made $632.00, approx 60-70% is profit

Upcoming Events:

- **Welcome to Kindie Night** - May 30, 6:15 pm. At least 1 more volunteer needed
- **Danceathon** - April 17, during school hours. 3-4 volunteers needed
- **Popcorn Days:** May 1, June 5
- **Freezie Sale Day** May, date TBD
- **Fun Fair:** June 12
- **Council Meetings:** April 15, May 13, June 17.

Playground Revitalization:

Playground quote:	Total cost is	$47,391
	WRDSB contributes	$21,048
	Our cost is	$26, 343

Motion to spend $26,343 to accept this quote for replacement of kindie playground PASSED 6-0.

Other Business:

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- ***Fun Fair: June 12p***
    - PRO Grant has been used to pay for the Foam Party (which has been booked)
    - KPL will have a button-making station and information about their summer activities
    - The Fire Dept will have a fire truck on site for kids to see, and will give out stickers
    - Looking into renting cotton candy machine, selling cotton candy
    - Plan to sell Halal and veggie dogs
    - ***Note: any parents with an idea for a booth at the fun fair (e.g. face painting? henna?) please contact the Suddaby School Council***
    - Suggested that an "equity lens" be incorporated - e.g add music from different cultures to the foam party
    - Looking into adding samosas to food sales.

- ***CFNA Garage Sale: May 25th***
    - Plans to add trunk sale to CFNA Garage Sale, in Suddaby parking lot. Options may include renting a spot and table to bring your own goods to sell (you keep the proceeds), and donating items to be sold at the Suddaby table (proceeds going to the school). Details TBD.

- ***Suddaby Track and Field:***
    - In recent years Suddaby's Track and Field day has been non-competitive. We do not record students' race times, long jump distances, etc. Consequently:

1) our students are not given ribbons or any recognition of where they placed
2) our students have no way of qualifying for Regionals

- This approach has the advantage of fostering an equally positive environment for all (as no one will be disappointed with their results).
- This approach also groups children by age, and not gender (unlike regionals), so children are not required to choose a gender.
- Several disadvantages were also raised, including:

1) T and F day may be the only opportunity some of our students have to compete, as not everyone is equally able to afford extracurricular sports for their children. We are denying those children this opportunity.
2) A friendly, yet competitive event can engender lessons on sportsmanship
3) Our students are at a disadvantage when they go on to other schools and are with classmates who have experience participating in full T and F days.

- Suggestions for a new approach included:

1) Allowing students to participate in either a “competitive” (timed, recorded) or a “recreational” (not recorded, just for fun) stream
2) Grouping students by age, but recording their results to allow them to go on and participate in the gendered Regional competition if the qualify, and wish to do so

- At this time, a final decision has not been made as to whether to have a competitive T and F day at Suddaby this year. Ms. Tompkins welcomes any further concerns, suggestions, or comments emailed to her.